

USE THE CONVERSATION BELOW TO ANSWER QUESTIONS 1—7

Mallory December 14, 2023

"I am new to buying K-pop concert tickets. How do I buy them before they sell out?"

Brianna December 20, 2023

"First of all, make sure you know the correct information about the tickets, such as when and where you can start buying them, the concert schedule, the price, etc. Also, decide what type of tickets that you're going for. Depending on the website, you will need to click on the type of ticket you want as fast as you can and buy them. Make sure you have your payment card and that you're already logged into or have created an account on the website beforehand. Good luck!"

PhillipG December 22, 2023

"If you want to get K-pop tickets, especially in Korea before they sell out, I would suggest using professional services that get concert tickets for people. They can book tickets for concerts and help buy tickets from resellers as well."

Elena December 23, 2023

"Buying K-pop tickets is like going to a war. It's really hard and stressful! I tried to do it last year and failed. I spent hours clicking and refreshing the website as the website kept crashing. Absolutely frustrating!"

Ishi December 27, 2023

"For me, the best way to get those best seller tickets is to watch out for them on both legit online ticketing sites and third-party reseller websites. Have patience, be strategic, and never give up!"

Jun December 30, 2023

"Don't worry about buying them before they sell out. You could go on Twitter or Facebook and find plenty of people trying to sell their tickets. I wouldn't stress over getting tickets the day they go on sale."

1. Which of the following is the issue stated at the beginning of the thread?

- A. Getting tickets for K-pop concert
- B. Selling K-pop concert tickets
- C. Buying tickets after they are sold out
- D. Being new to the K-pop industry
- E. Watching K-pop concerts in Korea

2. Brianna responds to Mallory's post in order to...

- A. Warn her that she will probably not get tickets
- B. Explain how to buy tickets directly on the Internet
- C. Suggest buying tickets using professional services
- D. Describe the website where she can buy the tickets
- E. Argue the importance of being able to pay for the tickets

3. Who explains the challenge of buying K-pop concert tickets by giving evidence?

- A. Brianna
- B. PhillipG
- C. Elena
- D. Ishi
- E. Jun

4. Who posts the least relevant answer to Mallory's question?

- A. Brianna
- B. PhillipG
- C. Elena

- D. Ishi
- E. Jun

5. The word "legit" in Ishi's post is closest in meaning to:

- A. Reasonable
- B. Authorized
- C. Protected
- D. Informal
- E. Illegal

6. Who suggests buying tickets from resellers on social media?

- A. Brianna
- B. PhillipG
- C. Elena
- D. Ishi
- E. Jun

7. What is the tone of the thread regarding buying concert tickets?

- A. Excited
- B. Concern
- C. Critical
- D. Supportive
- E. Amused

USE THE CONVERSATION BELOW TO ANSWER QUESTIONS 8—14

Bekind October 17, 2023

"Never thought I would ask this, but I will ask anyway. What's the greatest mental health tip you've ever gotten?"

Pandachef October 18, 2023

"Act like a detective and remove yourself from the mental health situation. Analyze from the outside and see what is really happening. You will soon realize that these thoughts are not yours. You can learn more how to handle your mental condition on this link."

101stKilo October 20, 2023

"If you need someone to talk to, please let me know. I offer professional services and receive payment via PayPal, bank transfer, credit card, etc."

Snails October 23, 2023

"Never evaluate your life when you're tired. Have you ever noticed things seem much worse at night when worries seem at their worst? The next morning, your brain can think of ways to fix them."

Brilliant October 23, 2023

"If you're not feeling mentally okay, then go to the doctor who handles that sort of thing. Don't be ashamed or embarrassed to seek help from health professionals."

Stara October 25, 2023

"Parent yourself the way your own parents never did. This could not be more accurate. I am parenting myself the complete opposite of how my parents did it, and it brings me such joy to know that I am not repeating their mistakes or deploying their standards of emotional neglect. Cheers!"

Della October 28, 2023

"Pretend you are your own child. Avoid negative self-talk. What would you say to your inner child if someone told them they were an idiot or useless? Practice a little kindness toward yourself."

8. Who suggests not to be hard on yourself?

- A. Pandachef
- B. 101stKilo
- C. Brilliant
- D. Stara
- E. Della

9. The word "professionals" in Brilliant's post is closest in meaning to ...

- A. Companies
- B. Leaders
- C. Specialists
- D. Clerks
- E. Administrators

10. The purpose of Snails' post is to ...

- A. Suggest that you do not need to worry at night
- B. Offer ways to evaluate the quality of life
- C. Make you aware of evaluating yourself at the most convenient time

- D. Recommend that you notice your problems
- E. Suggest that you evaluate yourself to fix your problems

11. Who posts the least relevant answer to Bekind's question?

- A. Pandachef
- B. 101stKilo
- C. Snails
- D. Stara
- E. Della

12. Which of the following issues is stated at the beginning of the thread?

- A. Being ashamed of a mental health problem
- B. Finding ways to manage mental health
- C. Struggling to manage health
- D. Looking for the best mental health professionals
- E. Comparing different tips for handling mental health

13. Who provides mental health tips by giving evidence?

- A. Pandachef
- B. Snails
- C. Brilliant
- D. Stara
- E. Della

14. What is the tone of the thread regarding mental health?

- A. Critical
- B. Hesitant
- C. Sympathetic
- D. Enthusiastic
- E. Judgemental

USE THE TEXT BELOW TO ANSWER QUESTIONS 15—21

Text 1

Americans are having fewer babies. At first, researchers thought the declining fertility rate was because of the recession, but it kept falling even as the economy recovered. Now it has reached a record low for the second consecutive year. The fertility rate subtly shapes many major issues of the day, including immigration, education, housing, the labor supply, the social safety net, and support for working families. Thus, there is a lot of concern about why today's young adults are not having as many children. As a result, research was recently conducted to investigate this phenomenon.

About a quarter of the respondents who had children or planned to said they had fewer or expected to have fewer than they wanted. The largest shares said they delayed or stopped having children because of concerns about having enough time or money. The survey tells a story that is partly about greater gender equality. Women have more agency over their lives. Many women feel that motherhood has become more of a choice. However, it is also a story of economic insecurity. Young people have student debt, many graduated in a recession, and many cannot afford homes. All these happen as parenthood has become more expensive.

One of the biggest factors was personal, which is having no desire for children and wanting more leisure time. This is a pattern that has also shown up in social science research. A quarter of poll respondents who did not plan to have children said that they did not think they would be good parents.

Financial concerns also led people to have fewer children than what they considered to be ideal. 64 percent said it was because children was too expensive. 43 percent said they waited too long because of financial instability. About 40 percent said it was because of a lack of paid family leave.

Text 2

Would you have a baby, or add more children to your family, if the government offers to help you cover the bills?

Government programs that give parents money for having kids are appearing in more and more countries as a strategy to combat declining birth rates.

Researchers study birth rates as a way to measure the stability of a community. In general, people will have children if they feel they have job security and stable economy. They will also want more children if they feel supported in starting a family. However, declining population growth can destroy the economy. Financial incentives and bonuses are one way to support parents and boost birth rates.

In one small municipality in Finland, Lestijarvi, fewer and fewer babies are born. Only one child had been born per year before 2013. Since then, local officials have given a "baby bonus" in which each baby born is worth 10,000 euros. This is paid to the family over the course of 10 years.

The bonuses for having children seem to be able to solve the problem of low birth rate in various places. This works in Finland, Estonia, Italy, Japan, and Australia. Governments can persuade parents to have children by promising easy childcare. They can also encourage women to have jobs while also having children.

15. According to text 1, what is one reason people say for not having children?

- A. They want to enjoy their lives without additional burden.
- B. They can simply adopt babies when they need one.
- C. The government does not give them money.
- D. Their parents do not support them to have kids.
- E. They want more money to support themselves in their old age.

16. The expression "have more agency over" in Text 1 Paragraph 2 is closest in meaning to:

- A. Acquire more establishment
- B. Own more enterprises
- C. Possess more control
- D. Keep more business
- E. Hold more offices

17. What is the main idea of Text 1?

- A. Americans do not have enough money, time, and ability to support more children.
- B. People are having fewer children because humans have become less fertile over the past century.
- C. The government can do various things to increase the country's population, such as giving parents money.
- D. Americans are more reluctant to have children because of economic, social, and personal reasons.
- E. Women are often blamed for decreased birth rate because they have become too independent.

18. Which of the following best restates the sentence "Would you have a baby, or add more children to your family, if the government offers to help you cover the bills?" in Text 2 Paragraph 1?

- A. Would you add more kids to your family if the state charge childcare bills?
- B. Would you want to have more children if the country provides financial assistance?
- C. Would you want to have more kids if it were possible to do so?
- D. Would you adopt more children if the government pays for the adoption fees?
- E. Would you have another baby if the government offers an easy childcare?

19. The author's purpose in writing Text 2 is to ...

- A. Inform that financial help seems to be an effective strategy to overcome declining birth rate.
- B. Calculate how much a government may spend to persuade people to have kids.
- C. Persuade readers to have more because it will strengthen economy.
- D. Prove that modern parents ask the government for more and more money.
- E. Compare the birth rate between rich and poor countries.

20. Which of the following statements shows the author's positive attitude toward government support?

- A. Young people have student debt, many graduated in a recession, and many cannot afford homes.
- B. Financial concerns also led people to have fewer children than what they considered to be ideal.
- C. Researchers study birth rates as a way to measure the stability of a community.
- D. In general, people will have children if they feel they have job security and stable economy.
- E. These bonuses for having children seem to be able to solve the problem of low birth rate in various places.

21. Which of the following can be concluded from both text?

- A. Children are becoming more expensive to raise, so the government must take the responsibility.
- B. To combat declining birth rate, countries must force their citizens to work harder and have more children.
- C. Providing good support for women can help overcome population decline.
- D. Having children in the modern era can cause economic hardship and loss of happiness for families
- E. Richer people tend to have less children, while poorer people tend to have more.

USE THE TEXT BELOW TO ANSWER QUESTIONS 22—27

Text 1

Rock weathering is a process of weakening and breaking down of rocks and minerals. Both non-living element, such as variations in temperature, flora and fauna, acids, salts, and liquid or solid water, can cause this. Rocks on the Earth's surface tend to weather faster than those underground. Weathering is one of the processes that lead to soil production. Different types of weathering affect rocks. These consist of chemical weathering, biological weathering, and physical or mechanical weathering. The process of physical or mechanical weathering essentially fragments rocks. Freezing and thawing water is one way that physical deterioration occurs. Water may easily pass through any pores or fissures in rocks while it is liquid. This water will expand inside those rocks if it freezes.

A weathering process known as honeycomb weathering can be triggered by salt. By capillary action, groundwater pours into rock pores and finally evaporates. This produces crystals of salt, which raise the pressure within rocks. The rocks will eventually break. This may leave behind honeycomb-like salt crystal pits. In dry areas, salt crystallization weathering is frequently observed.

Extremes in temperature can also have an impact on how rocks weather. Thermal stress is one term for one kind of physical weathering process. This is a typical feature of desert regions, where overnight lows can be relatively chilly and midday highs can be extremely hot. Over time, rocks that experience frequent extreme temperature swings will eventually fracture and flake, this process known as exfoliation.

Text 2

The deterioration and corrosion of rocks, metals, and man-made materials is known as weathering. Chemical and physical weathering are the two primary categories. Acid rain is one instance of chemical weathering for rocks. Scientists believe that rock weathering can play an important role in preventing global warming by controlling the amount of carbon in the atmosphere. The elements contained in volcanic rocks react with water or air in the atmosphere and absorb carbon.

Natural rock weathering process can take millions of years, making it too slow to counteract global warming. However, rock weathering accelerates when the rock is crushed into a fine dust. It is distributed throughout croplands worldwide, this "enhanced" rock weathering has the potential to store 215 billion tons of carbon dioxide over the course of the next 75 years, according to previous studies.

Researchers from University of California applied crushed rock, both metabasalt and olivine, on 5 acres of a fallowed cornfield in the Sacramento Valley. In comparison to plots without crushed rock, they discovered that during the study, the crushed rock plots stored 0.15 tons of carbon dioxide per hectare. If this amount of carbon was removed across all California cropland, it would be equivalent to taking 350,000 cars off the road every year.

It appears that many hardworking researchers are now looking for answers to how the process of rock weathering occurs in dry areas. It is known that drylands cover 41% of Earth's total area, and they are growing as a result of climate change. This, according to some prominent researchers, makes it even more crucial to look into improved rock weathering in drylands.

22. According to Text 1 Paragraph 4, what is exfoliation?

- A. The process of breaking and flaking of rocks due to frequent extreme temperature swings
- B. A type of volcanic rocks that significantly undergo frequent extreme temperature in dry areas
- C. An extreme thermal process on volcanic rocks usually due to frequent temperature swings in desert areas.
- D. One kind of chemical rock weathering where the pores inside the rock are triggered by the extreme temperature
- E. A typical feature of desert regions, where overnight lows can be relatively chilly and midday highs can be extremely hot

23. In Text 2 Paragraph 2, what does the word "it" refer to?

- A. Carbon dioxide
- B. Weathering process

- C. The rock
- D. Global warming
- E. A fine dust

24. Which of the following sentences from Text 2 is the author's opinion?

- A. The elements contained in volcanic rocks react with water or air in the atmosphere and absorb carbon.
- B. Researchers from University of California applied crushed rock, both metabasalt and olivine, on 5 acres of a fallowed cornfield in the Sacramento Valley.
- C. In comparison to plots without crushed rock, they discovered that during the study, the crushed rock plots stored 0.15 tons of carbon dioxide per hectare.
- D. It appears that many hardworking researchers are now looking for answers to how the process of rock weathering occurs in dry areas.
- E. It is known that drylands cover 41% of Earth's total area, and they are growing as a result of climate change.

25. What is the relationship between Text 1 and Text 2?

- A. Text 1 describes the different types of rock weathering processes whose effects on reducing the amount of carbon in the atmosphere are mentioned in Text 2.
- B. Text 1 describes the chemical and physical process of rock weathering, while Text 2 describes the influence of acid rain to the physical rock weathering.
- C. Text 2 describes the process of rock weathering in dryland areas studied by the researchers mentioned in Text 1.
- D. Text 2 explains the process of chemical and physical rock weathering whose causes are discussed in Text 1.
- E. Both texts describe the effect of rock weathering on reducing the amount of carbon in the atmosphere.

26. An explanation of rock weathering that occurs in dry areas can be found in ...

- A. Text 1 Paragraph 1, Text 2 Paragraph 3
- B. Text 1 Paragraph 1, Text 2 Paragraph 4
- C. Text 1 Paragraph 3, Text 2 Paragraph 4
- D. Text 1 Paragraph 4, Text 2 Paragraph 3
- E. Text 1 Paragraph 4, Text 2 Paragraph 4

27. Based on the information from both texts, which of the following will most likely happen in the future?

- A. Crushed volcanic rock containing metabasalt and olivine will be used as fertilizers for cropland in dry areas.
- B. Global warming will cause the natural process of rock weathering to happen more frequently.
- C. Acid rain will occur more frequently as a result of rock weathering in dry areas.
- D. Natural rock weathering process in dry areas will continuously be observed.
- E. A honeycomb weathering will be used to reduce the global warming.

USE THE TEXT BELOW TO ANSWER QUESTIONS 28—34

Text 1

Many young people will enter adulthood without knowledge and skills in finance. Young people need to have financial knowledge and skills. With these skills, they can make informed choices about their money. Consider these alarming statistics. Young Americans owe over \$1 trillion in debt. More than 70% of millennials live paycheck to paycheck. They always run out of money before getting their salary. Young people need financial education.

Financial literacy is the combined knowledge and skills to make responsible financial decisions. It contributes to a sense of financial security and well-being. Knowledge of financial concepts includes saving, investing, spending, and borrowing. It is the foundation of financial literacy. Understanding credit management and asset building is also critical to a healthy financial life. It includes how to reduce debt and avoid scams.

Low financial literacy threatens the well-being of individuals and families. Without a solid financial foundation, the youth are more susceptible to predatory lending. They also do not know how to manage debts and expenses. As a result, they get to lifelong financial inequity.

Low financial literacy can make people miss wealth opportunities. It reduces access to higher education and professional development training. When young people lack financial knowledge, they are more likely to become trapped in cycles of poverty and debt. For example, poor spending and borrowing habits often result in low credit scores. In turn, it contributes to higher financial insecurity.

Financial education is fundamental to improving financial health and well-being for our communities. However, developing financial capability is the ultimate goal. Financial capability is what happens when financial literacy knowledge is practiced and applied. It becomes second nature. Financial literacy drives behavior that consistently leads to positive economic outcomes. It gives individuals the confidence to make informed financial decisions. As such, they can take advantage of opportunities and build financial security for themselves and their families.

Text 2

As a teenager, have you ever seen your parents discussing something related to money? When you try to join conversation, do they either switch the topic? Do they say something like "We are doing something important, don't disturb"? Most of us wonder why they do this. Well, you are not exactly financially literate. They think it would be of no help at the moment. 'Financial Literacy' is defined as the ability to "understand and use various financial skills". This includes budgeting, investing, credit management, and personal financial management. It is considered to be one of the most undervalued skills. Financial literacy will determine a country's future. Financial education is extremely important. It will help you in building wealth, achieving goals, tackling challenges in case of emergencies, and securing your family's present and future!

Involving teenagers in day-to-day money matters, like managing household expenses, helps open their minds to certain financial aspect. Doing so will certainly help them become more responsible towards their spending habits. They will eventually realize how to spend little amounts of money and save as much as possible for when they need it. Money is an essential commodity in today's world. It is, therefore, important to master the concept of money management from the teenage years to achieve financial literacy.

28. The phrase 'paycheck to paycheck' in Text 1 Paragraph 1 is closest in meaning to ...

- A. With plenty of income
- B. Without borrowing money
- C. With more expenses
- D. By spending all the income
- E. By managing their income

29. According to Text 1, foundation of financial literacy is ...

- A. The knowledge and skills to make informed decisions
- B. Managing debts and expenses to avoid poverty

- C. Knowing how to reduces debt and make money
- D. The understanding of four key concepts in finance
- E. The understanding of credit management and investment

30. What is the main idea of Text 1?

- A. There are several tips for young people to avoid poverty and debt.
- B. The youth should be involved in making decisions about their money.
- C. Financial literacy is fundamental for teenagers.
- D. Money management in financial education is hard to understand.
- E. Young people have good understanding of financial literacy.

31. The purpose of Text 2 is to ...

- A. Argue that involving teenagers in handling daily expenses helps them develop financial literacy
- B. Explain the process of how teenagers can independently develop their financial literacy in the family
- C. Discuss that mastering the concept of money management is equally important as developing financial literacy
- D. Compare and contrast the development of financial literacy between teenagers and adults
- E. Provide instructions on managing day-to-day money for teenagers and parents

32. Which of the following best restates the sentence "It is, therefore, important to master the concept of money management from the teenage years to achieve financial literacy," in Text 2 Paragraph 3?

- A. In sum, helping teenagers to learn the concept of management is necessary for financial literacy.
- B. Financial literacy is, thus, crucial to be taught since school age to help teenagers master the financial concept.
- C. Arguably, developing financial literacy is important for all teenagers so that they understand the concept of management.
- D. Hence, learning how to manage money from young age is essential for developing financial literacy.
- E. Thus, the ability to manage money is the foundation of financial literacy for teenagers.

33. Which of the following statements shows the author's positive attitude toward the involvement of teenagers in managing daily financial matters?

- A. Young people need to have financial knowledge and skills.
- B. Financial literacy is the combined knowledge and skills to make responsible financial decisions.
- C. It is considered to be one of the most undervalued skills.
- D. Financial education is extremely important.
- E. Doing so will certainly help them become more responsible towards their spending habits.

34. What can be concluded from the two texts?

- A. Financial literacy affects young people's responsibility for their well-being.
- B. Financial literacy helps young people earn more money and avoid debts.
- C. The concepts of financial literacy should be learnt at school.
- D. Financial literacy matters for young people's future.
- E. Financial knowledge and skills can be applied in schools.

USE THE TEXT BELOW TO ANSWER QUESTIONS 35—42

Text 1

The average American may be swallowing a large amount of microplastic particles every year from contaminated foods. The report came from researchers at the University of Victoria in Canada who studied the microplastic content of certain foods. They combined it with dietary guidelines to estimate peoples' plastic consumption. They found the average American could be consuming 52,000 microplastic pieces each year by eating the recommended amounts of food and drink. This figure is slightly lower for women, at 41,000, because of their smaller food intake. Children have estimated annual Intakes of 46,000 and 39,000 microplastic particles.

There is growing concern that plastics in the ocean could be entering the food chain as microscopic particles absorbed by fish and molluscs. Other foods can be contaminated during production and processing or from plastic packaging. The study showed that bottled water could also be a significant source of microplastic consumption. An adult drinking only from bottled water may be consuming an additional 75,000 to 127,000 pieces of microplastic each year, according to the research. For comparison, drinking only from tap water leads to just 3,000 to 6,000.

The team emphasises that these figures are only estimates because of limitations in the data. They were not able to include common food sources, such as meat, dairy, cereals, and vegetables in their calculation because their microplastic content is not known. They also point out that it is unclear what effect this exposure to microplastics has on our health.

Text 2

Plastic infant feeding bottles can release up to 16 million pieces of microplastic during each use. Such bottles are routinely exposed to hot water and vigorous shaking when parents are making formula for babies. The researchers at Trinity College Dublin estimated the daily exposure of an infant up to 12-months-old ranged from 14,600 to 4.5 million microparticles. Although microplastics are also found elsewhere, such as in bottled water, their levels reported have been in the thousands per liter only. This means babies could be consuming doses thousands of times higher than adults.

The team assessed 10 different baby feeding bottles made from polypropylene. These are typically exposed to temperature of up to 100°C in a cleaning procedure advised by the World Health Organization. For one product, the number of microparticles increased from around one to 55 million particles per liter, when the temperature was increased to 95°C. 'Although is too early to make a policy based on this single study, the results ring an alarm,' according to an ecotoxicologist at Tge University of Southern Denmark.

The study will be pretty concerning for parents. However, frustratingly scientists also do not know what this means toxicologically, because there are so few studies on the health impacts of microplastics. Still, the scientists offer advice for parents. Formula should be prepared with hot water that is at 70°C or higher in a non-plastic container. When it has cooled, the formula can be transferred to the plastic bottles.

35. According to Text 1, more microplastic particles are accidentally consumed by humans through the following ways, EXCEPT...

- A. Bottled water
- B. Packaged foods
- C. Contaminated foods
- D. Marine animals
- E. Water tap

36. The word "their" in Text 2 Paragraph 1 refers to...

- A. feeding bottles
- B. babies
- C. microplastics
- D. parents
- E. researchers

37. Which of the following is an opinion from Text 2?

- A. Plastic infant feeding bottles can release up to 16 million pieces of microplastic during each use.
- B. Such bottles are routinely exposed to hot water and vigorous shaking when parents are making formula for babies.
- C. The team assessed 10 different baby feeding bottles made from polypropylene.
- D. Although it is too early to make a policy based on this single study, the results ring an alarm.
- E. When it has cooled, the formula can be transferred to the plastic bottles.

38. What is the relationship between the two texts?

- A. Text 1 describes the amount of microplastics from foods, while Text 2 describes the ones from beverages.
- B. Text 1 illustrates the impacts of microplastics to adults only, and Text 2 focuses on babies only.
- C. Both texts agree that the health effects of microplastics are well known.
- D. Both texts argue that avoiding microplastics in modern lifestyle is impossible.
- E. Both texts suggest that adults and babies may take a large amount of microplastics by drinking from a plastic bottle.

39. Statements that the impact of microplastic to human health is largely unknown can be found in...

- A. Text 1 Paragraph 1, Text 2 Paragraph 1
- B. Text 1 Paragraph 1, Text 2 Paragraph 2
- C. Text 1 Paragraph 1, Text 2 Paragraph 3
- D. Text 1 Paragraph 2, Text 2 Paragraph 1
- E. Text 1 Paragraph 3, Text 2 Paragraph 3

40. Based on the information from the two texts, which of the following will most likely happen in the future?

- A. More research will be conducted to investigate the impact of microplastics to human health.
- B. More parents will feed formula milk to their babies.
- C. The impact of microplastics to human health will remain a mystery for researchers are busy with climate crisis.
- D. All infant feeding bottles will be made from glasses.
- E. Seafood products will become less popular because of microplastics contamination from plastic packaging.